

27.4 KEY LANGUAGE USING REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS FOR EMPHASIS

Sometimes reflexive pronouns are not essential to the grammar of the sentence, but can be used to add emphasis in different ways.



The company director gave the talk.

This sentence makes sense without a reflexive pronoun.

Adding the reflexive pronoun at the end of the clause emphasizes that the action was not delegated.

The company director gave the talk *himself*.

[The company director gave the talk, rather than getting someone else to do it.]

Adding the reflexive pronoun directly after the subject emphasizes its importance.

The company director *himself* gave the talk.

[The company director, who is an important person, gave the talk.]



27.5 FILL IN THE GAPS WITH THE MOST APPROPRIATE REFLEXIVE PRONOUNS

The CEO himself came in to discuss his views about the merger.

- 1 I'm very impressed that they planned this conference _____ !
- 2 I spent all evening doing research for this presentation _____ .
- 3 The area is traditional, but the city _____ is full of modern offices.
- 4 Nobody helped us. We won this contract _____ .
- 5 I couldn't believe it! The Queen _____ presented the award.
- 6 Marta writes summaries for her boss. He can't write them _____ .
- 7 It's very important that you fix these problems _____ , Jacob.
- 8 The company founders _____ will be making the final decision.

